

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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EXPERIENCE

StaffRoom AI

Emeryville, CA

Founder & AI Solutions Consultant

October 2023 - Present

- Ran discovery conversations with non-technical clients. Collected missing details, explained the options in plain language, and wrote clear next steps so they could decide with confidence.
- Kept several client threads moving at once over email and Slack. Held a consistent professional tone and accurate notes on every thread.
- Mapped unwritten client processes into procedures and working systems their staff could run without a call. Flagged what to change when the numbers did not match the story.
- Modernized a client's ingestion pipeline, validating data across systems. Throughput rose 99.8% in 4 months and cost fell 86%.
- Trained an IT services team to run a new pre-sales workflow on their own. Processing time on their risk assessments fell 98%.
- Owned intake through close-out: statements of work, forms, milestone tracking, and complete records for clients up to \$18K.

Wiz Music

Barcelona, Spain

Community Development Intern

May 2022 - July 2022

- Segmented churn and join sources, found that reported membership growth was not organic, and raised it with the team.
- Ran Discord operations in English, Spanish, and Catalan, including an artist AMA against an engagement gap.

IBM, Customer Support

Austin, TX

Data Engineer / Cognitive Software Engineer

August 2018 - December 2020

- Built custom internal software for support operations: a data pipeline and reporting workflow. Cut log-prep time from 1-3 hours per case to none.
- Built Tableau and Cognos reports for operating teams and C-level executives so decisions sat on numbers the teams could trust.

Alpha Phi Delta, University of Colorado Boulder

Boulder, CO

Rush Chair

January 2019 - December 2021

- Owned the membership funnel: hosted rush events, built the recruitment profiles the chapter used, matched prospects to a fit, and converted them to signed bids.

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder

Boulder, CO

B.S. Information Science (Major GPA 3.7); Certificate of Cognitive Science

2018 - May 2023

- Senior capstone: built the backend for a camping-trip planner. It pulled campground, weather, and alert data and turned Leave No Trace practice into a game.
- Dean's List, Fall 2019 and Spring 2023. Information ecosystems, user-centered design, applied machine learning, and technical communication.

Certifications: EMT (2024); AIARE 1 (2022); IBM Systems & Solutions Architecture Professional Certificate (in progress).

SKILLS

Communication: professional tone across email and Slack; client intake; explaining options in conversation and in writing.

Analysis & reporting: SQL, Python, Tableau, Cognos; pulling signal from operational data and writing what to do next.

Systems & operations: process mapping; custom internal tools; forms; statements of work; Microsoft Office; complete records. Quick to ramp on new systems.

Matching & discovery: asking questions, mapping needs, recommending a fit.

Travel & languages: live aboard a 1966 sailboat on the SF Bay; Barcelona internship; AIARE 1; EMT; camping-trip planner capstone. English (native), Spanish (conversational; two years of university coursework).